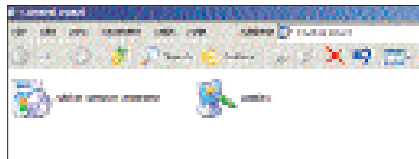


and choose Enabled. When you log on next, you'll only see the system clock in the tray, which you can also remove by right-clicking on the Taskbar, selecting Properties and un-checking "Show the Clock".

Select Control Panel Applets

You can choose to show only a given set of Control Panel applets to users. The option is under User Configuration > Administrative Templates > Control Panel. On the



You can decide which Control Panel icons you want users to see

right-hand side, you will see "Show only specified Control Panel applets". You'll need to know the exact names of the Control Panel applets to use this, though. For example, appwiz.cpl corresponds to Add/Remove Programs and so on.

Get Rid Of The Update Nag

Aren't you frustrated by the number of times Windows asks you if you want to restart after an update? It won't even listen if you tell it to restart later! Here's how you can get rid of that.

In group policy, you'll find this blissful setting under Local Computer Policy > Computer Configuration > Administrative Templates > Windows Components > Windows Update > Reprompt for restart with scheduled installations. Done! Now all you have is an icon in the system tray to remind you in the unobtrusive way that it should have in the first place. ■

Bet You Didn't Know

The Office 2003 Line Irritant

If you enter a series of hyphens or underscores in Word (2003 or 2007) and hit [Enter], it autocorrects to a line that covers the full width of the page. This is all very nice, but what about when you want to get rid of that line? Unlike Office XP, you *can't* just hit delete and be rid of it! The line is created as a border, so the solution is to go to the borders button on your toolbar and choose "No Border" (that's the box with all its lines dotted).

MEDIA PLAYERS



We're all obsessive about our music and movie collections, and ergo, about our media players. Here are some handy guidelines to use your favourite programs better.

WINAMP



Use The Global Hotkeys

For some reason, this feature has been disabled by default, but it's extremely useful if you're listening to music while working on another program and don't want to bother yourself switching to Winamp to change the song you're hearing. Go to Options > Preferences (or [Ctrl] + [P]) > Global Hotkeys and check Enable. All the hotkeys are simple [Ctrl] + [Alt] shortcuts that work even when Winamp isn't in focus. You can even add your own and customise what exists—which you might need to because volume controls sometimes don't register with Windows XP.

Don't Read IDs3s All At Once

By default, Winamp will load a song's information as soon as it's queued into the playlist. If you've loaded a large number of files, though,

you might want to reduce the time between Winamp starting up and your music actually playing. Go to Options > Preferences > Titles (under General Preferences) and select "Read metadata only when files are played".

Really Random Music

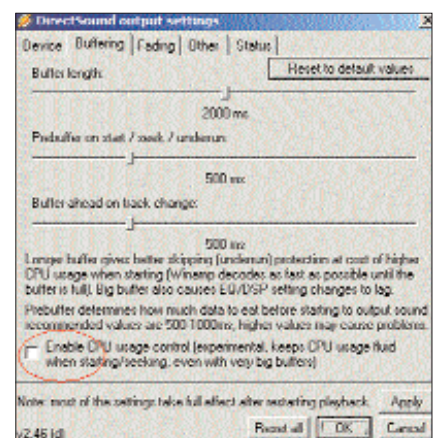
One quirk with Winamp is that when using the Shuffle feature, you might wind up listening to the same set of songs over and over again—we've seen situations where out of 500 songs in a playlist, only 200 were played often, and the rest rarely. This is actually expected behaviour, since shuffling doesn't necessarily mean that songs won't be repeated. You can tweak the Shuffle Morph Rate in the preferences (Options > Preferences > General Preferences > Playlist), but if the results don't satisfy you, turn off the shuffle feature and instead, click on Misc. in the playlist editor and select Sort > Randomize List for a truly random playlist.

Magic With Music

If you're having one of those days when you need to hear only slow, depressing songs, or if you're having a party and don't want any of the aforementioned songs getting in your way, use the MusicMagic plugin that comes bundled with Winamp. It analyses your music and relates tracks according to their "acoustic fingerprint", so similar-sounding tracks fall under the same playlist. You can access it from the Media Library (it's the second entry from the bottom) and change its settings under Options > Preferences > Media Library > Predixis MusicMagic.

Don't Load Your Old CPU

If you've experienced choppy sound from Winamp while you worked on Word or Excel, especially on older PCs, Winamp might be taxing your CPU



Prevent Winamp from embarrassing your old PC